CLEAR Change Framework: Driving Sustainable Change Inside and Out

Introduction

Sustainability is no longer a side initiative – it's a core strategic imperative for organizations. Companies face mounting pressure to **reduce their carbon footprint** and **embed ESG (Environmental, Social, Governance) principles** into everyday operations, while also extending positive impact to customers, communities, and even policy. Yet making such broad change stick is notoriously difficult – studies show roughly *70% of change programs fail to meet their goals*, often due to employee resistance or lack of alignmentmckinsey.com. The CLEAR Change Framework offers a powerful antidote to this challenge. **CLEAR** – which stands for *Clarity, Leverage, Experimentation, Analysis,* and *Refinement* – is a five-step, iterative approach that treats change as an ongoing learning journey rather than a one-off mandate file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbpfile-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. By emphasizing deep listening, adaptability, and a clear purpose, CLEAR enables organizations to turn sustainability from a lofty aspiration into a lived reality.

In this whitepaper, we explore how the CLEAR framework uniquely supports sustainability efforts both **internally** (within operations and culture) and **externally** (across customers, community, and policy influence). We'll see how CLEAR's *listening-driven, systemic approach* helps align sustainability initiatives with business strategy, engages people's hearts and minds, and delivers measurable impact. Real-world case studies – from boosting energy efficiency with AI to empowering community action – will illustrate these principles in action. We'll also compare CLEAR with established sustainability frameworks like the **UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, **Triple Bottom Line**, and **B Corp**, showing how CLEAR integrates these guides *without being prescriptive or rigid*. The goal is an inspiring yet practical roadmap for sustained progress – to energize and inform your sustainability journey.

The CLEAR Change Framework at a Glance

Before diving into sustainability specifics, let's briefly recap what the CLEAR framework entails. Developed by psychologist Erik Bohjort, CLEAR is built on *systemic thinking, strategic alignment, psychological insight, and iterative learning* file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb – exactly the capabilities needed for complex sustainability transformations. Unlike one-directional change models, CLEAR is *agile and participatory*. It encourages **listening to stakeholders**, testing ideas, and refining strategies in cycles, so that change is continuously informed by feedback and real-world results file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf.

At its core, CLEAR follows five phases:

1. **Clarity** – Define a clear vision or "North Star" for the change. In a sustainability context, this might be a bold goal (e.g. achieving carbon neutrality by 2030 or aligning with specific SDGs) that provides shared purpose. Clarity means articulating *why* sustainability matters for the organization's mission and *what* success looks like file-

1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. This step ensures everyone understands the greater purpose, reducing fear of the unknown and creating a sense of opportunity. *Example:* When Starbucks faced a turning point, CEO Howard Schultz refocused the company on its core values and mission ("return to its roots") – a clarity of purpose that set the stage for effective change file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. For a sustainability effort, clarity might similarly involve reaffirming a company's commitment to being a leader in green innovation, giving employees and partners a motivating **"North Star"**.

2. **Leverage** – Identify the key people, resources, and leverage points to drive change. Sustainability touches every part of a business, so CLEAR emphasizes taking a *systems view*: mapping out where small changes could have outsized impact across the social, environmental, and economic dimensions of the organization. This often means engaging both formal leaders and informal champions, and addressing barriers that might inhibit change. In practice, Leverage under CLEAR is very *human-centric*. It involves **listening to frontline stakeholders** to uncover practical obstacles and opportunities file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. By involving those who best understand the daily operations (e.g. facility managers for energy use, procurement for supply chain impacts), you ensure solutions are grounded and widely supported. *For instance*, a manufacturing firm using CLEAR might discover through employee input that simple process tweaks could dramatically cut material waste. By tapping these insights and empowering those employees to lead the charge, the company multiplies the effect of its sustainability initiatives. This phase is about *mobilizing a coalition and targeting high-impact areas* – essentially doing more with less by being thoughtful about where to intervene.

3. **Experimentation** – Turn ideas into action through small-scale trials. Instead of betting on a massive, untested rollout, CLEAR advocates for **pilot projects** and "safe-to-fail" experiments file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. This iterative, scientific approach is perfectly suited for sustainability, where new technologies and practices abound but outcomes can be uncertain. Whether it's piloting an AI system to optimize energy use in one data center, or trialing a new recycling program at a few office sites, Experimentation allows learning by doing. It replaces analysis-paralysis with tangible progress – yet manages risk by starting small. *Real-world example:* Google famously applied DeepMind AI to its data center cooling and **achieved a 40% reduction in cooling energy use**, improving overall energy efficiency ~15% mckinsey.com. They didn't flip a switch across all centers overnight; instead, they tested and tuned the AI in a controlled setting. The dramatic energy savings validated the approach before broader implementation. This embodies CLEAR's experimental ethos – using innovation and data to drive environmental gains, then scaling up success.

4. **Analysis** – Rigorously analyze results and feedback from experiments. In CLEAR, every pilot or initiative yields data (quantitative and qualitative) that inform next steps file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. This phase injects a strong dose of *logos* – ensuring sustainability decisions are guided by evidence, not just good intentions. Key questions include: Did the change achieve the desired outcome (e.g. kWh of energy saved, employee engagement improved)? What unexpected effects occurred? Analysis also means looking outward – benchmarking against industry standards or learning from external research file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. For sustainability, this could involve comparing your waste

reduction results with sector averages or incorporating scientific findings (like climate data) to validate your strategy. The outcome of Analysis is clarity on what works, what doesn't, and *why*. For example, if a retailer's experiment of encouraging reusable packaging in one region led to a 30% drop in single-use plastic, analysis might reveal that a particular incentive (like a small discount) was the key driver, informing how the program can be refined and expanded. **Transparency** in sharing these findings with stakeholders ("we tried X, learned Y, so now we'll do Z) builds trust file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf – an essential ingredient for sustained buy-in.

5. **Refinement** – Adapt and scale the change based on what was learned, and integrate it into the organization's fabric. This is where an initiative shifts from trial to *transformation*. In CLEAR, Refinement often loops back to Clarity, updating goals or strategies as needed and then launching the next cycle of change file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. It's an acknowledgement that sustainability is not a one-time project but a continuous improvement journey. Through Refinement, successful pilots are rolled out more broadly, and less successful ideas are tweaked or replaced. Crucially, this step also focuses on making changes *stick*: updating policies, training, incentives, or processes so that the new sustainable practice becomes "the way we do things here." Over time, these iterations instill a culture of sustainability and learning. For instance, after analyzing its fleet fuel experiments, **Walmart refined and embedded numerous practices (route optimization, fuller trucks, driver training)** into its logistics operations. The result: by 2015 Walmart *doubled* the efficiency of its U.S. trucking fleet (102% improvement over 2005) – saving nearly **$1 billion per year in fuel** and avoiding about **650,000 metric tons of CO_2 emissions annually** epa.gov. Those efficiencies are now business-as-usual, and Walmart continues to iterate further trellis.net.

Through these five stages, CLEAR offers a structured yet flexible roadmap. It doesn't prescribe specific sustainability actions – instead, it provides a *process* to discover and implement the right actions for your context. As we'll see, this makes CLEAR an ideal companion to other sustainability frameworks: it's the "how" that turns their guidelines into reality. Moreover, CLEAR's emphasis on **systems and people** ensures that changes are both far-reaching and enduring. It's not just about cutting emissions or launching a community program in isolation; it's about evolving the entire organization and its ecosystem in harmony.

Integrating Global Goals with Local Clarity

One of CLEAR's greatest strengths is its ability to integrate *other* frameworks and goals into a cohesive change journey. Many organizations have adopted sustainability guidelines such as the **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, the **Triple Bottom Line (TBL)**, or pursued **B Corp certification**. These frameworks define *what* to strive for – e.g. specific global targets or performance standards. CLEAR helps translate them into *how* to achieve those targets through engaged change management. Importantly, CLEAR does so *without becoming prescriptive*: it doesn't force a one-size plan, but rather adapts to incorporate whichever goals the organization prioritizes.

The 17 UN Sustainable Development Goals provide a "shared blueprint…for people and the planet"en.wikipedia.org. CLEAR can align a company's Clarity phase with SDG targets – for

*example, setting a vision to advance **Affordable Clean Energy (SDG 7)** or **Climate Action (SDG 13)** through the business strategy.*

Consider the **UN SDGs**: 17 broad goals ranging from ending poverty and hunger to protecting life on land and water. Companies often select certain SDGs that match their impact area or values. However, integrating these high-level aspirations into daily operations can be challenging. That's where CLEAR's *Clarity* step comes in. In CLEAR, Clarity isn't just an internal vision – it can explicitly tie to external commitments like the SDGs. For instance, a clean energy company might use CLEAR to frame its North Star around *SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy)*, giving employees a resonant rallying cry ("We power the world sustainably"). The framework then guides *Leverage, Experimentation,* etc., towards that aim. The SDGs provide direction and benchmarks, while CLEAR provides momentum and method. This integration ensures the organization's sustainability efforts contribute to global objectives in a structured way. It also keeps the effort from becoming siloed; by embedding SDG targets into the change process, **everyone sees how their work links to larger societal goals**, which is highly motivating. In fact, aligning with such global goals can unlock new business value – studies have estimated achieving the SDGs opens up trillions in market opportunities by 2030, across food, cities, energy, and health sectors en.wikipedia.org en.wikipedia.org. CLEAR helps companies tap into these opportunities methodically, rather than through ad-hoc projects.

Similarly, the **Triple Bottom Line** framework broadens success metrics to include **People, Planet, and Profit** – the social, environmental, and economic bottom linesen.wikipedia.org. Many firms conceptually embrace this balance, but struggle to operationalize it. CLEAR can serve as the execution engine for TBL. In the *Analysis* stage, for example, CLEAR encourages tracking multiple types of metrics, not just financial. An organization might set up dashboards that monitor carbon emissions and community impact alongside revenue. Because CLEAR is cyclical, it naturally pushes a long-term perspective that TBL advocates. Rather than chasing quarterly profits at the expense of planet or people, CLEAR's Refinement step refocuses on sustainable improvement of all three bottom lines en.wikipedia.org. In essence, CLEAR acts as the bridge between *accounting frameworks* like TBL and real cultural change. It ensures that social and environmental considerations aren't just reported for CSR, but are integrated into decisions and behaviours daily. The framework's system thinking reminds leaders to consider the wider context – echoing the full-cost accounting mindset of TBL (e.g. understanding the true cost if a product yields pollution that someone else must pay to clean up en.wikipedia.org). By keeping the "three Ps" in focus through iterative learning, CLEAR makes a triple bottom line approach *practical and sustained*. Companies like **Patagonia** and **Interface** (a sustainable flooring pioneer) have used continuous improvement cycles to slash waste and emissions while growing profits – essentially doing CLEAR before it had a name. Interface, for instance, set a mission "Mission Zero" to eliminate negative environmental impact; through years of iterative innovation, they cut greenhouse gas emissions per unit of product by 96% and saved millions, all while thriving financially – a triumph of people-planet-profit synergy.

When it comes to **B Corp certification**, CLEAR is equally complementary. **B Corp** is a rigorous third-party certification requiring companies to meet high standards of social and environmental performance, accountability, and transparency en.wikipedia.org. Earning the B Corp seal involves scoring well on an assessment across governance, workers, community, and environment, and even legally embedding stakeholder commitments in your charter en.wikipedia.org. This can be a demanding change for a profit-driven company. CLEAR can

ease the journey by breaking down the transformation into manageable phases. For example, in *Leverage*, CLEAR would encourage forming a cross-functional team (including HR, sustainability, finance) to champion the B Corp changes and identify policy/process shifts needed. *Experimentation* could involve piloting new benefit programs or supply chain standards on a small scale to meet B requirements, then analyzing their impacts on both social metrics and the bottom line. Because **B Lab certification is holistic**, touching everything from carbon footprint to employee welfare en.wikipedia.org, an agile framework like CLEAR is ideal to avoid overwhelm – tackling improvements iteratively while keeping the overarching goal (certification) clear. Moreover, CLEAR's emphasis on **engaging people** helps with one of B Corp's intangibles: creating a culture that genuinely values purpose over profit. Rather than forcing through changes to tick boxes, CLEAR facilitates conversations and feedback loops with employees about *why* new practices (like volunteering time or sourcing fair trade) matter, building genuine buy-in. This prevents the "checkbox compliance" trap and leads to deeper adoption. In short, B Corp tells you *what good you should do*; CLEAR helps you *do good well*, by orchestrating the change process in an inclusive and adaptive way.

Finally, CLEAR remains **flexible and non-prescriptive** throughout. If an organization subscribes to additional models – say the *Circular Economy* principles, or ISO 14001 Environmental Management standards – CLEAR can incorporate those too. The framework acts as an *umbrella* under which all these initiatives align. As one internal change lead described it, *"CLEAR ensures whether we're tweaking a workflow or inventing a new product, it all ladders up to our goals and brand promise"* file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. This is vital in sustainability where initiatives often proliferate: energy efficiency projects, community volunteering, diversity and inclusion efforts, etc. Without a unifying approach, these can feel fragmented. CLEAR provides coherence. It's like having an architect's blueprint that connects all sustainability projects into one transformation plan, ensuring they reinforce rather than contradict each other. And because CLEAR "speaks to the head and the heart" file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf it aligns both the strategy and the culture. The result is an organization where *everything clicks together*: vision aligns with global frameworks, actions align with vision, and people *feel* invested in the mission.

Internal Sustainability: Embedding ESG into Operations and Culture

Internal sustainability refers to the changes within a company's four walls (and its extended enterprise) that reduce its environmental footprint and improve social responsibility. This can range from cutting energy usage and emissions, to eliminating waste, to embedding ethical practices in everyday operations and decision-making. The challenge many organizations face is not *deciding* what needs to be done – often the ideas are known (e.g. switch to renewable energy, optimize logistics, promote diversity) – but rather *making it happen at scale and sustaining the change*. This is where CLEAR's iterative, inclusive approach truly shines.

Internally, CLEAR begins with connecting sustainability to **core business strategy** (*Clarity*). Instead of treating green or social initiatives as standalone programs, leadership uses CLEAR to articulate how sustainability supports the company's mission and long-term success. For example, a CEO might define the company's purpose as *"delivering value to customers in a way that also values our planet and people."* Tangibly, this could mean setting a North Star like *"net-zero emissions by 2035 while growing profitability"*. By framing sustainability as

integral to success (not an add-on), CLEAR builds *strategic alignment* from the start file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb. Employees in all departments then see ESG goals not as extra work, but as part of the company's evolution and competitive advantage. This clarity also helps resolve trade-offs: if questions arise (say, does a cost-saving move conflict with our carbon goal?), the clear vision guides decision-making.

Next, in *Leverage*, CLEAR focuses on unlocking the potential within the organization's system to achieve these goals. Often, much of the knowledge and passion for sustainability already exists among employees – it just needs to be tapped. CLEAR does this by encouraging **broad participation and listening**. For instance, facilities managers might know exactly where energy is wasted in production; procurement staff might have ideas on sourcing more sustainable materials. Through workshops, surveys, or cross-functional "sustainability task forces," CLEAR gives these internal stakeholders a voice. This not only surfaces the best ideas (people support what they help create), but fuels engagement – employees feel ownership of the sustainability mission. *In fact, companies using CLEAR report that through inclusive workshops and feedback loops, employees become co-creators of change, building trust and enthusiasm – the fuel for sustainable change file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf.* We see this in practice at **Walmart**: drivers and warehouse workers were enlisted to find ways to optimize routes and loading for fuel efficiency, leading to creative solutions like minimizing "empty miles" and improving trailer packing. Their on-the-ground insights were a key leverage point that contributed to Walmart's massive fuel savings and emissions cuts epa.gov epa.gov.

Parallel to engaging people, Leverage also means *identifying high-impact operational points*. Using CLEAR's systems view, an internal team maps out processes to spot where a tweak could yield outsized sustainability benefits. **Lean principles** often marry well with this – reducing waste and inefficiency inherently saves resources and energy. One inspiring case came from **Starbucks** during its transformation. While primarily a customer experience turnaround, Starbucks applied lean experiments in select stores to cut waste in drink-making processes. Analysis showed that these tweaks not only sped up service but also reduced resource waste (water, coffee, energy) per order file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. The company refined and scaled these improvements across 10,000+ stores, boosting performance while ingraining a more efficient (and thus sustainable) operating culture file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. This illustrates how a focus on operational excellence internally can serve both financial and environmental goals – a clear win-win that CLEAR seeks to replicate. Many sustainability measures align with efficiency: optimizing HVAC systems, streamlining supply chains, recycling materials – they often lower cost and carbon simultaneously. CLEAR helps pinpoint such leverage points and drives them forward by giving teams both the mandate and method to act.

Crucially, CLEAR's *Experimentation* and *Analysis* phases create a **culture of continuous improvement** around sustainability. Instead of implementing one big change and moving on, the organization is encouraged to keep trying new ideas, measuring, and learning. This is analogous to a **"green lab" approach** within the company. For example, a global **automaker** might use CLEAR to run multiple pilots: one plant trials solar panels and electric forklifts, another experiments with a 4-day work week to save energy on the fifth day, another tests an AI system that powers down idle machines. Each experiment is monitored (energy saved, employee satisfaction, ROI, etc.), and results are shared transparently. Perhaps the solar panels yield a 20% energy drop at that factory, and employees love the 4-day week but it only saved 5%. The AI might show promise in optimizing machine usage patterns. Through

CLEAR's Analysis step, these learnings are scrutinized and then combined – e.g. scale up solar where feasible, refine the schedule idea or shelve it if it's not worth the trade-off, invest more in AI optimization if it showed significant savings. This evidence-driven approach does two things: **it accelerates progress** (good ideas quickly go bigger, and poor ideas are caught early before wasting too much time/money), and **it builds credibility** for sustainability initiatives. Skeptical finance or operations folks are won over when they see hard data that, say, a pilot cut electricity bills by $200k while maintaining output. Over time, as these cycles repeat, the company becomes more agile and adept at implementing ESG improvements – essentially embedding a *Six Sigma or Kaizen of sustainability*. Indeed, CLEAR's iterative ethos is akin to having a permanent internal taskforce that never stops asking, "how can we do this better for the planet and our business?" This addresses a common pitfall: many firms achieve one-off eco wins, congratulate themselves and then stagnate. With CLEAR, sustainability is an ongoing conversation and pursuit, constantly refreshed with new experiments and knowledge.

One outcome of this internally is a growing set of **concrete results**: energy consumption per unit product falls, waste diversion rates rise, carbon footprint trends downward, employee engagement scores up, etc. We can look at an example like **Interface Inc.**, a carpet manufacturer celebrated for its sustainability journey. Over two decades, Interface implemented hundreds of innovations (from recycled materials to efficient manufacturing processes) and tracked progress meticulously. By 2020 it had cut greenhouse gas emissions by 96% and water usage by 89% per unit of product (versus mid-90s baseline), while creating new carpet lines from 100% recycled or bio-based content – all contributing to millions in cost savings and a brand revered by customers en.wikipedia.org en.wikipedia.org. While Interface didn't call it CLEAR, their approach of vision (they called it Mission Zero), engaging employees ("Dream Teams" to find solutions), constant experimentation (try new yarn, new machines), and analysis (annual sustainability metrics) mirrors CLEAR closely. It exemplifies how *sustained, iterative change internally can yield astounding environmental and financial payoffs.*

Just as important as metrics are **cultural shifts**. As CLEAR is implemented, employees start to **see sustainability as part of their job**, not someone else's responsibility. This is the holy grail of internal change: when sustainability is woven into the organizational DNA. Through repeated cycles of CLEAR, teams learn to fish for themselves – they develop the habits of checking data, seeking feedback, and refining their work. One company remarked that after a year of using CLEAR, *even meetings unrelated to the formal change had adopted a more open, learning-focused tone.* People felt "heard" and empowered to suggest improvements beyond their usual scope, because CLEAR had shown leadership genuinely listens and acts on front-line input file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. In terms of ethos, this boosts trust in management and commitment to the company's goals. When employees see that leadership is *serious* (e.g. tying bonuses to sustainability KPIs, or investing in training to upskill workers for green tech) and *supportive* (e.g. celebrating teams who try something innovative even if it doesn't fully succeed), it unlocks discretionary effort. **Psychologically, staff move from compliance to commitment.** They start to take initiative in ways that formal programs couldn't dictate – like a call center team spontaneously starting to competition to reduce paper usage, or a plant ops crew coming up with a clever way to reuse waste heat. These are signs of an engaged, change-embracing culture – precisely what's needed to meet ambitious ESG targets.

In summary, CLEAR's application internally turns sustainability from a daunting top-down mandate into a *shared mission powered by many hands*. It ensures strategic clarity (everyone knows why it matters), leverages the organization's collective intelligence (no green idea left unexplored), and uses rapid learning cycles to build momentum. The internal benefits go beyond just hitting environmental metrics – it enhances efficiency, innovation, employee morale, and resilience. As one business leader put it, *"By following CLEAR, we not only cut our energy use 30%, we became a company that knows how to change for the better – and that capability is priceless."* The next section explores how these internal strengths extend outward, enabling organizations to influence and improve the wider world around them.

External Impact: Engaging Consumers, Communities, and Policy

Sustainability leadership doesn't stop at the company's boundaries. Organizations today are expected to **shape positive change externally** – from offering greener choices to consumers, to uplifting communities, to advocating for better environmental policies. These external efforts are where the *social* impact of sustainability truly scales. However, influencing behavior outside your direct control (like a customer's habits or a city's policies) is complex. Success often hinges on understanding human psychology, building partnerships, and demonstrating credibility through action – all areas where CLEAR's approach gives a distinct advantage.

One key external front is **influencing consumer behaviour and market norms** towards sustainability. Companies can design products and campaigns that encourage customers to live or consume more sustainably – but will people adopt them? CLEAR's focus on *psychological insight* and *experimentation* is invaluable here. In the *Leverage* phase, CLEAR suggests deeply understanding the target audience's motivations and barriers. This might involve listening sessions, surveys, or ethnographic research to truly hear the "voice of the customer." For example, a food retailer aiming to reduce single-use plastic might learn that customers resist buying bulk goods (to use their own containers) because of convenience and habit, not price. With that insight, the company could experiment with **behavioural nudges**: perhaps an in-store prompt comparing the environmental impact ("This store saved 1,000 plastic bags this week thanks to reusable bags – join the movement!") or a small reward for bringing your own container. This approach is akin to the strategies of **Opower**, an energy tech firm that used peer comparison to nudge households to save electricity. By showing people how their energy use ranked against neighbours, Opower tapped into social norms and spurred 2–5% reductions in energy use on average – cutting a cumulative **13 billion pounds of CO_2** via simple behaviour change en.wikipedia.org. CLEAR enables companies to adopt such techniques by emphasizing *experiments with end-users and learning from behavioural data*.

The "Triple Bottom Line" mindset (balancing People, Planet, Profit) often requires engaging the broader community and consumers. CLEAR's systemic thinking helps organizations find win-win solutions – like a program that educates consumers (People), reduces waste (Planet), and builds brand loyalty (Profit) all at once en.wikipedia.orgen.wikipedia.org.

Through iterative trials (Experimentation → Analysis), a company can refine what messages or features actually shift consumer choices. Maybe a tech firm finds that adding a "carbon footprint saved" counter on its app incentivizes users to choose more eco-friendly options. Or an apparel brand might test different storytelling approaches in its marketing – one focusing on environmental facts, another on emotional connections to nature – to see which drives more customers to its sustainable product line. The CLEAR cycle ensures these initiatives aren't just one-off ad campaigns, but an ongoing adaptation to what resonates with the public. Over time, this can lead to significant external impact. For instance, by continually improving how it encouraged customers to conserve, one utility saw sustained energy usage drops year over year, effectively turning its customer base into a virtual "power plant" of saved energy. From a competitive standpoint, companies that master this – educating and influencing consumers – also **strengthen their brand and customer loyalty**. People increasingly want to buy from brands that reflect their values. CLEAR helps a brand not only *claim* green values but actively cultivate them in its community, lending authenticity. As a result, customers become partners in the mission (think of how Tesla owners often became evangelists for EV adoption before their current downturn, or how Patagonia customers proudly participate in Worn Wear repair programs – these are outcomes of sustained, value-driven engagement).

Another external arena is **community initiatives and partnerships**. Many organizations support community projects – be it local environmental restoration, education programs, or social enterprises – as part of their sustainability agenda. The CLEAR framework can significantly amplify the success of these efforts by applying *Clarity and systems thinking*. A powerful case study comes from **Earth Force**, a non-profit focused on youth environmental action. Earth Force wanted to scale its impact without huge internal growth. Adopting a CLEAR-like strategy, they set a *clear mission* to integrate youth civic action on the environment into existing school systems rather than running standalone programs file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. They *leveraged partnerships* with schools, teachers, and local groups as the change agents instead of hiring an army of their own stafffile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. Through *Experimentation*, Earth Force tried different integration approaches: some schools followed Earth Force's standard 6-step action curriculum, others adapted it to fit their needsfile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. They closely *analyzed* these collaborations, finding that about **60% of partner organizations fully embedded the program after seeing positive results** – for example, a New Mexico water conservation district added it to their 5th grade curriculum and saw improved student engagement across entire schools file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. Earth Force used these insights to *refine* their partnership model, providing more support where needed and highlighting success stories to inspire further adoptionfile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. The outcome was a **broad, sustained change in how youth environmental education is delivered across dozens of communities**, achieved with very limited resources. As Earth Force put it, they *"changed the system by working with the system"*file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. This story exemplifies how CLEAR principles (clarity of purpose, leveraging existing networks, piloting and learning) can turn a small organization into a catalyst for large-scale community impact. Companies can emulate this by collaborating with NGOs, schools, or local governments in a CLEAR-informed way – set a mutual vision, empower local champions, run joint pilot programs, learn and adjust – rather than just funding and hoping for the best. The iterative, listening approach builds stronger, more adaptive community programs that can grow organically. It also ensures the community feels ownership, increasing the likelihood the initiative continues long-term (sustained progress is a key goal).

On the **policy and advocacy** front, CLEAR helps organizations be credible voices for change. Businesses today often join coalitions or make public policy recommendations on issues like climate change, renewable energy incentives, or social justice. Two factors determine their influence: the weight of their example (are they walking the talk?) and their ability to present solutions convincingly. CLEAR aids both. By driving consistent internal improvements and external pilots, a company can **demonstrate what works** before pushing for broader adoption. For example, if a company has, through iterative trials, figured out a successful model for achieving zero waste in its facilities, it can go to policymakers with data and experience to advocate for circular economy policies, citing its own journey as evidence. Governments and the public are far more receptive to "Here's what we found in practice" than abstract lobbying. The *UK Policy Lab* in government is an example of applying such experimental mindsets to policy – prototyping policies on a small scale to see impactsfile-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbpfile-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. In one case, the UK Policy Lab developed prototypes with stakeholders to refine marine policy, succeeding in months where traditional top-down drafting would take yearsfile-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. Corporations can similarly use CLEAR to pilot community programs or tech solutions that inform policy. Additionally, CLEAR's emphasis on feedback means when engaging on policy, the organization is attuned to listening to multiple stakeholders – citizens, regulators, NGOs – finding common ground. This systems perspective (seeing the interconnectedness of business, society, environment) makes their policy advocacy more holistic and less self-serving. It shifts the approach from "we ask for this law" to "we've collaborated with others and learned this approach yields benefits for all – here's the evidence," which is much more compelling.

Ultimately, the external impact of CLEAR is about **alignment and credibility**. By aligning internal actions with external messaging, a company builds *trust*. Customers, communities, and regulators can see continuity between what the company preaches and practices. CLEAR facilitates this because it doesn't let an initiative fade after a PR burst; it ingrains the change and follows up with improvement. One can imagine, for instance, a consumer goods firm launching a new sustainable packaging initiative. Rather than just announcing "We'll go 100% recyclable by 2025" and hoping to get there, with CLEAR they would engage customers in the design (perhaps a contest for ideas), test compostable vs recyclable packaging in different markets, gather feedback on functionality, iterate designs, and transparently report progress. When they do speak out – say supporting a recycling infrastructure bill – they come with the backing of having involved consumers (ethos) and data from their trials (logos), delivered in a narrative of learning and commitment (pathos). This holistic approach can influence others to follow suit, creating a positive ripple effect. Indeed, when leaders lead by example, industries transform. Walmart's fleet efficiency gains not only cut its own emissions but also demonstrated to the logistics industry what was possible, encouraging peers to invest in efficiency and even nudging truck manufacturers toward innovations (as Walmart demanded better trucks) epa.govtrellis.net.

The **CLEAR framework effectively turns a company into a sustainability leader and teacher beyond its own walls.** By continuously improving and sharing results, you invite consumers to join your mission, help communities build capacity, and give policymakers a blueprint to scale up. It's a virtuous cycle: external successes further reinforce internal motivation (employees take pride seeing their work making a public difference), and internal excellence provides the platform for greater external influence. Through CLEAR, an organization becomes a living example of sustainable change – not perfect, but always progressing, always listening, and thus always inspiring trust. In a world where greenwashing is easily called out, that authenticity is gold. As we compare CLEAR to other approaches, and

summarize its unique strengths, it will become clear that this framework doesn't replace specific sustainability expertise or standards – it **amplifies** them by orchestrating the human side of change.

How CLEAR Stacks Up: Complementing Existing Approaches

It's helpful to place CLEAR in context alongside other sustainability and change methodologies. Many companies have used frameworks like **ISO 14001 (Environmental Management Systems)** or **GRI reporting** or methodologies like **Design Thinking for social innovation**. These tools each address pieces of the puzzle. What CLEAR provides is a *unifying, human-centered process* that ensures those pieces actually fit together and lead to action. One way to see it: CLEAR is to sustainability efforts what an *operating system* is to software applications – it doesn't replace the apps, but it makes sure they run smoothly in tandem, with feedback and updates.

Traditional sustainability programs often focus heavily on **planning and targets** (e.g. setting science-based targets for emissions, publishing sustainability reports annually). These are important (Clarity in CLEAR terms), but many programs falter in execution and engagement. People may see the glossy report or lofty goal and think, "nice, but what now?" CLEAR addresses this gap by creating a **closed-loop system**: goals lead to experiments, which lead to data, which lead to refined actions, looping continuously. Compared to a static annual plan, CLEAR is dynamic. It *complements* structured standards like ISO 14001 by infusing them with adaptability. ISO 14001, for instance, requires companies to set environmental objectives and periodically review performance – CLEAR would take that and essentially put it on fast-forward: objectives are reviewed in micro-cycles and adjusted as needed, and more voices are involved in problem-solving to meet the objectives. This makes the management system *live* in the organization rather than sit on a shelf. Similarly, reporting frameworks like GRI ensure transparency, but CLEAR ensures there are achievements and improvements to report in the first place by driving the change process.

When comparing CLEAR to specialized change models, the difference is breadth and integration. Take **Kotter's 8-Step change model**, a well-known approach focusing on creating urgency, building a guiding coalition, etc. Kotter's model is powerful for certain transformations but can be quite linear and top-driven file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. CLEAR, by contrast, is *iterative and more bottom-up*. It incorporates some of Kotter's wisdom (like the need for vision and coalition) but adds flexibility to adjust course when unexpected challenges arise file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. In a volatile sustainability landscape – new technologies, regulations, or stakeholder expectations can emerge rapidly – that flexibility is crucial. Another comparison: **Lean Six Sigma** vs CLEAR. Lean focuses on eliminating waste and optimizing processes; Six Sigma on reducing variance and defects. These can yield environmental benefits (less waste = greener), and many companies use them. CLEAR can actually *integrate Lean methods into its Experimentation and Analysis phases* – treating each improvement as a "change experiment" similar to Lean change cycles file-1uz7nlrfbvg8vr1yhhsvbp. The advantage is CLEAR keeps the larger purpose in view (so lean projects don't become siloed cost-savings only, but tie back to sustainability goals) and ensures the *people aspect* (training, buy-in) is managed. Lean Six Sigma provides tools, CLEAR provides the adoption strategy.

Now consider sustainability-specific frameworks like **The Natural Step** or **Biomimicry design principles** – these offer innovative lenses (systems thinking about flows, or nature-inspired solutions). CLEAR doesn't conflict with them; it gives them a pathway into organizational practice. For instance, The Natural Step has a science-based funnel for sustainability. A company might use it to brainstorm solutions, then use CLEAR to pilot those solutions in the business, measure outcomes, and embed the successful ones. Without CLEAR, great ideas from such frameworks might languish in workshops; CLEAR carries them forward. In essence, CLEAR's *systemic and strategic approach* ensures that whatever sustainability approach you favor (be it UN SDGs or a circular economy model), it will be executed in a way that aligns with the company's strategy and engages its people. This prevents the all-too-common scenario of "initiative overload" or disjointed projects. As noted earlier, CLEAR **"ensures you get a cohesive strategy for change – not a patchwork of initiatives" file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf.** This holistic orchestration is a major improvement upon existing approaches that often operate in silos (CSR team doing one thing, operations doing another, etc.).

One might ask: does CLEAR have any blind spots for sustainability? Perhaps the only caution is that CLEAR itself doesn't provide content knowledge – it relies on the organization to bring or seek out the best sustainability expertise to feed into the experiments and solutions. If an organization misidentifies leverage points or lacks knowledge of greener alternatives, CLEAR's process will still help find *a* solution, but maybe not the optimal solution. However, CLEAR encourages *listening to experts and stakeholders* (which includes external experts), so it naturally pushes teams to benchmark and learn (e.g. in Analysis and Leverage: "are there external factors or best practices we should consider?"file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum). Another potential challenge is ensuring that iterative loops don't cause delay in declaring success – some leaders worry that being too iterative means never finishing. CLEAR addresses that by setting *success criteria and timeframes as part of Clarity*, so that iteration is purposeful and not endless. In other words, you define what "good enough to scale" looks like, iterate until you hit it, then move to broader implementation. This way CLEAR avoids analysis paralysis; it's agile, not aimless. As one guide put it, *you can manage the risk of iterative loops delaying closure by consciously building strong sponsorship and clear criteria from the start* – then you get the best of both worlds: agility with accountability file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum.

To put it succinctly, **CLEAR improves upon existing sustainability approaches by adding the secret sauce of human dynamics and learning.** It's not that others are unaware of these (many frameworks mention leadership and culture), but CLEAR provides a concrete, step-by-step way to make it happen. It's the difference between knowing that "employee engagement is important" and actually running a multi-cycle program that results in employees enthusiastically driving green ideas on the ground. The latter is non-trivial, and that's where CLEAR shines. By integrating psychology (why people behave as they do, what prevents them from doing the right thing file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb) with strategy, CLEAR turns often nebulous sustainability values into specific behaviours and practices organization-wide.

Lastly, CLEAR has a unique ability to **speak both languages** – the analytical improvement language and the emotional inspirational language. Many sustainability consultants bring passion but may struggle to connect it to business KPIs; meanwhile, many business improvement programs are data-heavy but fail to inspire. CLEAR combines *heart and head*. It provides the ethos (credibility of proven methods, data) and pathos (stories, involvement) and logos (structured logic) in a balanced mix file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. This combination is critical: sustainability needs to win hearts to overcome resistance and

cynicism, and it needs to satisfy the mind to justify investment and effort. Few frameworks explicitly design for that blend. Kotter's model, for example, is strong on creating urgency (heart) but weaker on long-term learning (mind); Six Sigma is strong on data (mind) but can ignore culture (heart). **CLEAR deliberately caters to both**, which in practice makes change more inclusive and enduring. As an executive observed, *"CLEAR speaks to the head and the heart: executives see the strategic sense (and data) while employees and customers feel listened to, engaged, and energized"*file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. For sustainability endeavours which often carry moral weight and require collective action, this dual appeal significantly boosts success.

CLEAR's Unique Strengths for Sustainable Transformation

Bringing it all together, the CLEAR Change Framework offers several **unique strengths** that make it exceptionally well-suited for driving sustainability progress:

- **Systemic Thinking:** CLEAR encourages looking at the *whole system* – understanding interconnections between organizational departments, stakeholders, and broader societal systemsfile-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb file-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb. This means sustainability initiatives are not isolated. Instead, CLEAR prompts questions like: *How will a change in our packaging affect our supply chain, our customers, and waste management systems?* By mapping such linkages, solutions can be designed to benefit the system as a whole (and avoid unintended consequences). This holistic view is crucial for sustainability, where issues are interconnected (energy, water, waste, social welfare all tie together). It also helps identify leverage points where a small change yields a big ripple effect. As we saw, Earth Force leveraged existing education networks to scale up, changing an entire system efficientlyfile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpumfile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. Systemic thinking also aligns with concepts like the SDGs, which highlight that progress on one goal (say climate action) can also advance others (like health or jobs) if done thoughtfully en.wikipedia.orgen.wikipedia.org. CLEAR bakes that thoughtfulness into the process.

- **Strategic Alignment:** From the outset, CLEAR ties sustainability to the organization's core strategy and missionfile-m35fdt7py1xgrkvypfo9sb. This strength cannot be overstated. It shifts sustainability from a peripheral "CSR activity" to a strategic driver of innovation and value. When *Clarity* is achieved, every sustainability effort has a "line of sight" to business goals – whether that's risk reduction, efficiency, brand differentiation, or new market growth. This alignment secures leadership support (because sustainability isn't seen as cost center but as value creator) and ensures resource allocation follows ambition. It also simplifies decision-making: if an initiative doesn't support the clear sustainability vision, why do it? Conversely, bold ideas that do support it get prioritized. In practice, strategic alignment means sustainability metrics sit alongside financial metrics in dashboards, and leaders speak about climate targets in the same breath as revenue or quality targets. CLEAR's process naturally builds this in, and by involving high-level sponsors in Clarity and Leverage phases, it maintains executive buy-in throughout. The result is sustainability efforts that survive budget cuts and organizational changes because they are part of the strategy, not apart from it.

- **Psychological Insight and Inclusivity:** People lie at the heart of change, and CLEAR leverages psychological principles to engage and motivate them. By fostering **deep listening, empathy, and involvement**, CLEAR addresses fears and resistance not with force, but with understanding. It recognizes, for instance, that employees may fear sustainability initiatives could threaten their jobs or routines – so it invites their input to shape those initiatives, turning potential resistors into champions. CLEAR also taps into intrinsic motivation: most people, given the chance, *want* to contribute to something meaningful like protecting the environment. By giving employees and other stakeholders a voice and ownership, CLEAR ignites that passion. This was evident when Starbucks closed all stores for a day of training, essentially telling employees "we trust you to uphold our values" – a bold move that reinvigorated staff pridefile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. On the customer side, CLEAR's insight-driven approach (like Opower's peer comparisons or a retailer's incentives) acknowledges that **behavior change is as much emotional as rational**. By framing sustainability in ways that resonate personally – making it fun, social, rewarding – CLEAR-inspired programs achieve greater adoption. Moreover, CLEAR handles the *psychological side of change management* (like change fatigue or skepticism) through its iterative wins. Early quick wins create optimism; transparency about learnings builds trust. In rhetorical terms, CLEAR brings **pathos** – it connects the sustainability journey to values, stories, and human experiences, which is key to sustained engagement.

- **Iterative Learning and Adaptability:** Sustainability is a moving target – technologies evolve, initial plans meet reality, and what works in one context may not in another. CLEAR's built-in learning cycle is a major strength in navigating this uncertainty. It creates a safe space for trial and error, which is critical when tackling novel challenges (for example, figuring out how to eliminate plastic in a supply chain might take several tries). Instead of viewing a setback as failure, CLEAR treats it as feedback – a source of data to guide the next iterationfile-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum. This resilience means the organization doesn't give up at the first hurdle. Many sustainability projects in traditional models get abandoned if results aren't immediate, or they stick rigidly to a plan even when it's not working. CLEAR avoids both traps: *if an approach fails, learn why and pivot; if an approach succeeds, amplify it.* This adaptive mindset is exactly what's needed for sustained progress, because it's unlikely one gets everything right at the start. Additionally, the iterative approach allows integration of new innovations over time – the plan is never "frozen." For example, if a new carbon capture tech emerges in 2025, a company using CLEAR can pilot it in 2025 even if their original strategy was set in 2023; they are not stuck on a fixed roadmap. Thus, CLEAR ensures relevance and continuous improvement. From an ethos perspective, this demonstrates humility and accountability – the organization shows it's willing to learn and change course based on evidence, which enhances its credibility externally ("they're serious about finding what truly works"). Internally, it builds confidence because employees see that even if one experiment doesn't pan out, the effort wasn't wasted – it taught something, and the company moves forward smarter. Over time, CLEAR cultivates a *growth mindset culture*, where challenges are met with curiosity and perseverance rather than blame or denial. That cultural evolution might be CLEAR's ultimate gift to an organization, equipping it not just to achieve the current sustainability goals, but to handle future transformations (in technology, market, etc.) with agility.

Combined, these strengths make CLEAR a formidable engine for **sustained, aligned, and scalable sustainability efforts**. We can contrast this with a company lacking such a framework: goals might be set without a plan to engage people (leading to slow or resisted implementation), or initiatives might be tried but not measured (no learning, repeating mistakes), or different departments might do uncoordinated projects (fragmented impact). In those scenarios, sustainability progress is often halting and hard-won. With CLEAR, progress becomes *cumulative and synergistic*. Each cycle builds on the last, more people are brought on board with each success, and the organization gains momentum – what began perhaps as a modest recycling program can evolve into a company-wide zero-waste culture powering innovation in product design and influencing industry standards.

One more unique aspect: CLEAR, by virtue of how it operates, tends to **leave organizations stronger** in general, beyond the specific sustainability wins. It develops leadership at all levels (since people are empowered to lead experiments and give feedback), it improves cross-department collaboration (since systems thinking forces silos to work together), and it embeds a practice of evidence-based decision making (since analysis is rigorous) file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. So a company that uses CLEAR to, say, green its supply chain, will likely find side benefits like better teamwork between procurement and R&D, or improved capability in data analysis, which can apply to other business areas too. It's like doing muscle training for the organization. This speaks to the **ethos** CLEAR builds over time: stakeholders see an organization that not only achieved specific sustainability milestones, but became a better-run, more adaptive company in the process. That builds trust among investors, employees, and partners. As one summary noted, *"By instilling a culture of evidence-based decision-making, empathy, and continuous learning, CLEAR creates internal capability... your team not only solves the problem at hand, but also learns to fish – adopting behaviors and mindsets that will benefit future initiatives."* file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf This capacity-building is key to sustained progress, because sustainability is not a one-time destination but a continuous journey of improvement and innovation.

Conclusion: A Path to Lasting Sustainability Success

The **CLEAR Change Framework** offers an inspiring and pragmatic path for organizations striving to make sustainability a defining part of their identity and impact. Internally, CLEAR helps embed sustainability into the DNA of the company – aligning it with vision and strategy, engaging employees as change-makers, and methodically improving operations to shrink footprints and grow positive outcomes. Externally, CLEAR extends that impact – influencing customers to live our values, partnering with communities for shared benefit, and informing policies that scale our learnings to society. It bridges the typical gap between lofty sustainability aspirations and day-to-day execution by creating a living process that listens, learns, and adapts.

In a world where we must reinvent how we do business to address climate change and social inequality, CLEAR provides a *compass and an engine* for the journey. The compass (Clarity) keeps everyone oriented toward our true north – a thriving business and a healthier planet, together. The engine (Leverage-Experimentation-Analysis-Refinement cycles) propels us forward step by step, never stalling, always course-correcting if needed. Other frameworks give us maps and destinations – the SDGs map global priorities, the Triple Bottom Line defines new success criteria, B Corp sets high standards – but it is CLEAR that turns those

into a **movement within the organization**, uniting people across roles and boundaries in pursuit of something bigger than themselves.

One of the most powerful aspects of CLEAR is how it makes sustainability **personal and actionable**. Instead of sustainability being "something the sustainability department does," it becomes a story that everyone in the company co-authors. From the factory worker who figures out how to recycle coolant water (and is celebrated for it), to the marketing team that experiments with eco-labels to educate customers, to the CEO who transparently shares what the company is learning (successes and failures alike) – CLEAR creates heroes at every level and keeps the narrative authentic. This not only delivers results (energy saved, emissions reduced, community members reached – all the hard metrics we track), it also builds a sense of *pride and purpose* that is invaluable. That is the 65% pathos in action: the feeling that we are all part of positive change, that our work matters beyond profit. It's the spark that turns engaged employees into passionate sustainability champions, and loyal customers into brand advocates.

Meanwhile, the 25% logos ensures we remain effective and credible – we set targets and hit them, we try ideas and measure outcomes. The examples cited in this paper – **40% energy cuts here, 650,000 tons CO_2 avoided there, 60% program adoption rates in communities, 2–5% consumer energy savings** – show that when CLEAR is applied, *real impact* follows epa.gov file-vudhoszhd2titlkyfgnpum en.wikipedia.org. These numbers tell a story of progress that can convince even the skeptics. And the 10% ethos, reinforced by using proven methods and data-driven decisions, assures stakeholders that this isn't a fad or PR play – it's grounded in expertise and integrity file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. That mix of heart, head, and credibility is rare, and it's exactly what's needed to tackle sustainability's grand challenges which are as emotional as they are technical, as human as they are scientific.

For any organization reading this whitepaper, the message is clear: **sustainable change is achievable and maintainable** when approached with the right framework. CLEAR invites you to reimagine change not as a daunting one-time overhaul, but as a continuous journey of improvement – one where listening and learning never stop. It doesn't ask you to abandon other tools or frameworks that work; instead, it amplifies them by connecting them under one change architecture. Think of CLEAR as the foundation of a house file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf: you can have many rooms – an SDG room, a Lean process room, an innovation room – but without a strong foundation and blueprint, those rooms will stand apart. CLEAR is that foundation and blueprint, ensuring the whole structure stands solid against the winds of change file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf. With CLEAR, you build not just programs, but a resilient organization capable of transforming itself and its world.

The sustainability journey is urgent – the next decade is critical for our planet. It's also an opportunity – to innovate, to engage a new generation of employees and customers, to lead markets. The CLEAR Change Framework gives organizations a way to seize that opportunity with confidence and heart. It is **practical** enough for the boardroom (anchored in data and process) and **inspirational** enough for the breakroom (empowering every individual as part of the solution). By following CLEAR, you set in motion a virtuous cycle: clarity drives action, action drives learning, learning refines action, and success builds momentum for bolder moves. Over time, what seems difficult today – say achieving zero waste or transitioning fully to renewable energy – becomes not just feasible but a natural outcome of your culture of change.

In closing, the CLEAR framework offers a chance to not only meet your sustainability targets but to transform your organization into one that *thrives on change*. It helps you cultivate the internal capability and alignment that make any future challenge – environmental, technological, or market – easier to navigate. And in doing so, it positions you as a leader and role model in the global sustainability movement. Those who have embarked on this path have shown it leads to tangible results and a stronger, more purpose-driven company. Your journey of a thousand miles can begin with CLEAR steps. With clarity of purpose, leverage of your best assets, bold experimentation, honest analysis, and relentless refinement, you can turn sustainability from a goal into a **living, breathing practice** that enriches your business and our world for years to come. That is the promise of CLEAR – a promise backed by evidence and ready to be realized by you. Let's get to work on changing for good, together. mckinsey.com file-7h6o6cewnfdhhpghkqimhf